

Workshop

We tell you how to create a seamless content consumption life to attain true entertainment bliss across all devices



Your new resto-manager

Clicktable.com launches its new cloud based software for restaurants, making front desk management more efficient

Feature

a whole set of apps in one, with a highly customisable lock screen equipped with thousands of themes to choose from and a whole lot of personalization options.

The themes can be the usual abstract backgrounds, one that looks like a Windows phone home screen or even one that changes its form with the current weather. The customisable options available at your fingertips range from the ability to turn off notifications to hiding the status bar or date and time. For securing your device, this lock screen replacement would probably give you even more than the stock lock screen – right from the usual passcode or pattern to a neat gesture unlock, which is entirely exclusive to this app.

If you're one of those who wants to be offered something fresh every time you hit the lock button, this one's for you. You can even set your themes to a 'random' mode so as to not have to manually change them frequently. With a new theme welcoming your eyes every time you turn on your screen, this lock screen replacement application is more than just a sweet treat and will add a dash of excitement to the seemingly humdrum activity of switching on your phone.

4. Next Lockscreen

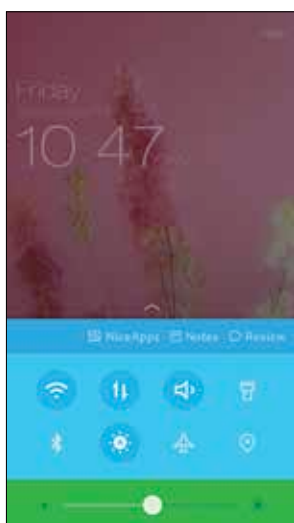
Right when Microsoft decided to have a home screen launcher of their own, they also came up with a beautiful lock screen replacement application for their Android



Cover Lockscreen Home



Microsoft's Next Lockscreen



ZUI Locker - Swipe up control panel

fans. This one amalgamates the best of both, form and function, seamlessly.

The first look of the lock screen is sure to grab eyeballs, as you're compelled to notice the incredible photo backgrounds provided by Bing, which can be periodically updated. Once you begin to tinker around with it, you'll find a Launchpad at the bottom of the screen when you swipe up. This combines applications and quick settings, and will remind you a little of the iOS 9 quick settings. What's interesting here is that the apps in the launchpad change according to your location. Basically, the applications you mostly only use when you're in the office will pop up right when you reach work, by intelligently picking up patterns in the course of your usage.

As for other customisation options, Microsoft lets you manage which notifications are displayed, change the weather settings, show the music player and also gives you the ability to hide apps on the launchpad. For securing your device, the usual passcode and pattern lock options are available.

A neat and well-designed lock screen that fulfils its purpose with élan and doesn't carry a monotonous feel, this one's a keeper.

5. ZUI Lockscreen

One of the more obscure options available on the Google Play Store, this lock screen replacement application will surely add colour to both your device and your life, with

its smooth animations, bright colours and overall fresh look.

The swipe-up control panel which forms the base of this lock screen needs a special mention. On swiping up from the bottom you'll notice a colourful panel filling the screen with quick settings and lock screen settings. Here you can even customize the app shortcuts and set them according to your convenience. Adding to the life of the lock screen is an animated parallax for a wallpaper. So if you tilt your phone towards the right, the background will move towards the left giving you a panoramic view. Theming options, though limited, are also available to your liking.

The level to which you can secure your device with this lock screen is also noteworthy. For your safety and privacy, there are options to even lock the status bar or hide message previews altogether, along with the usual passcode and pattern lock, which also come with a colourful and interactive twist. This is truly the app's highlight, as it even lets you unlock your phone by tapping on images of your favourite people by replacing them as numbers. It makes the entire process fun and your device secure – especially from that one particularly nosy relative who's always peeking into your phone to get a glimpse of your passcode. This lock screen replacement application will inspire a smile every time you unlock your device.

Conclusion

Lock screens were generally used to prevent restrict access to your device or to prevent accidental screen brushes from opening an application. Today, however, with its myriad features, the lock screen actually makes you forget actually having to unlock your device, along with delivering a customized experience of their own. To reinforce and step up the entire experience of each of these applications, I would also recommend you download the launchers that come with them, if any.

As for the one we liked best, it's the Next Lockscreen by Microsoft, which is wonderfully minimal in design and meets all your needs. If none of these fir your needs, you can browse the Play Store and pick one of the several hundred other options available.